Lessons

Perimeter

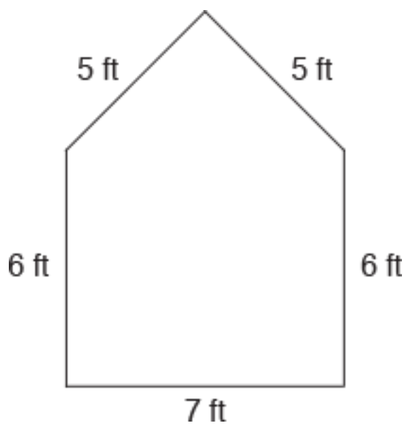
Toolbox

Perimeter

Perimeter (P) is the distance around a flat figure with straight sides. Perimeter problems are often about fencing an area or putting a frame or trim around an object.

Perimeter formulas exist, but you really don't need them. To find the perimeter of any shape, simply add the lengths of its sides.

The perimeter of this five-sided figure is 5 + 5 + 6 + 6 + 7 = **29 feet.**

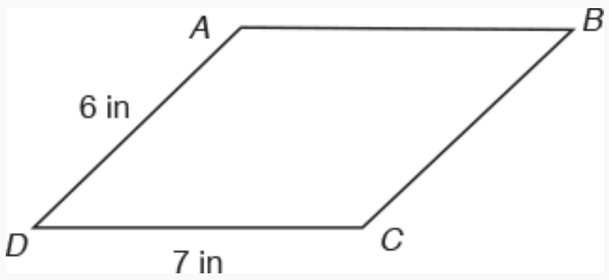


Perimeter is a measure of length. Typical units of measure for perimeter are inches, feet, yards, miles, centimeters, meters, and kilometers.

Example

Hide

What is the perimeter of the parallelogram?



Step 1

Two sides are not labeled. However, since the figure is a parallelogram, you know that opposite sides are equal.

AD and BC = 6 inches

DC and AB = 7 inches

Step 2

Add to find the perimeter.

6 + 6 + 7 + 7 = 26

The perimeter of the parallelogram is **26 inches.**

Key Terms

base

height

perimeter

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Lesson 2: Perimeter and Area

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